

Preston Carey Leslie

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Kaiser Permanente Northwest IT Recruitment Team
Nicolai Service Center
Portland, OR

RE: Systems Administrator III, Health Systems (Job Number: 1410809)

Dear Kaiser Permanente IT Hiring Team,

Large-scale enterprise software applications frequently fracture at the exact boundary where backend system configuration meets real-world business operations. When database architectures undergo massive transitions, the resulting technical debt does not simply exist as broken code. It manifests as operational friction, data collection bottlenecks, and systemic frustration for the end-users relying on that system to deliver care. I am applying for the Systems Administrator III position within your Health Systems team because your department is searching for an analytical investigator who can operate comfortably in the space between technical development teams, third-party software structures, and end-user configurations. Having recently completed my Master of Science in Quantitative Methods and Modeling from Baruch College, I am completely unencumbered and prepared to relocate to the Portland area immediately to support your enterprise systems on day one.

Your candidate requirements present a deliberate option: you are looking for an administrator with either two years of direct Epic build experience, or two years of foundational programming and scripting capabilities. My background aligns perfectly with the latter, bringing a strong foundation in Python and SQL programming that I am eager to scale into intermediate systems development within your health systems ecosystem. This technical toolkit is backed by hands-on operational experience within the health care industry. During Callen-Lorde's transition from NextGen to Epic, I navigated the core system architecture for an 18,000-user ecosystem. My role focused on database data quality, collection, and preservation during the migration. Stepping into the technical static of this transition, I audited source-to-destination field mapping to preserve critical Electronic Health Record (EHR) demographic layers. Additionally, I engineered a manual tracking system using Microsoft Excel to capture capacity telemetry and monitor system bottlenecks; through independent root-cause analysis, I successfully identified an unflagged hardware-level capacity constraint, providing the data-driven troubleshooting and problem solving needed to justify a new pilot division.

My programming and scripting foundations have been further proven through engineering complex technology integration pipelines during my graduate portfolio work. In my Complaints & Inspections (CI) project, I

architected a serverless ELT pipeline on Google Cloud Platform, utilizing Python extraction services on GCP Cloud Run to systematically manage API ingestion, handle offset pagination, and enforce structural schema validation into a unified Kimball star schema. Furthermore, in my Social Determinants of Health (SDOH) initiative, I served as Technical Lead utilizing Pandas and Statsmodels to deploy an offset Poisson regression model, writing debugging scripts to handle privacy-suppressed negative integers and troubleshoot structural data anomalies. In my most recent WHO Project, I'm designing a serverless AWS (Lambda, S3) cloud framework to transition manual, high-friction referral workflows into an automated technology integration pipeline.

An exceptional Systems Administrator must possess the meticulous attention to detail of a programmer, paired with the active listening and relationship-building skills required to gather complex customer requirements. Over a 15-year career spent navigating fluid operational roles, representing 300+ personnel in complex labor governance negotiations, and translating systemic friction into clear technical support runbooks, I have proven my ability to drive continuous improvement under pressure. I look forward to bringing this exact blend of quantitative discipline, troubleshooting capability, and cross-group collaboration to the Kaiser Permanente Northwest IT division.

Thank you for your time, consideration, and dedication to maintaining highly resilient health application systems.

Sincerely,
Preston Carey Leslie